

Project 12

Course Code and Name: MSJ 3243: Speech Writing and Public Speaking

Project Name: Network Propaganda about Chittagong Hill Tracts

Project Type: Speech writing

Project Theme: Network Propaganda

Semester of Submission: Spring 2025

Project Description:

This project involved writing and delivering an extemporaneous speech on Network Propaganda about the Chittagong Hill Tracts (CHT). The speech explored how different stakeholders, including the government, Indigenous communities, and other groups, present different narratives about the CHT conflict. It focused on the role of propaganda, media, and communication in shaping public opinion and understanding of this sensitive issue.

Project Justification:

The Chittagong Hill Tracts is an important and complex issue in Bangladesh's history. This project was conducted to understand how different perspectives and communication strategies influence public perception and highlight the importance of balanced, ethical, and responsible communication.



Final Project

MSJ 3243: Speech Writing and Public Speaking

(Sec 1:)

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Network Propaganda about Chittagong Hill Tracts

Introduction

পাতা ছেঁড়া নিষেধ, Hello everyone, imagine a place where old traditions and modern problems live. In January 2025, a violent clash happened in Motejheel Dhaka between local students and indigenous students, severely injuring the conflict student, removal of the word Adibasi, and a poster. And was attacked by 20 indigenous people by a Local student. Yes, this is the Chittagong Hill Tracts conflict in Bangladesh as sharply as it is misunderstood.

Body

Today, we will discuss Network propaganda issues. A real example is the war of network Propaganda in the Chittagong Hill tracts. About 70% of Bangladeshi students admit they have no idea about the Chittagong Hill Tracts conflict. All of the bangles accept that these tribal people are not Indigenous; they are enemies of our country. But why did we get here? The answer lies in propaganda through social media, a tool for conflict expansion today.

1st of all, we must know what it is and how it can be used as a poison. Propaganda is more than just political slogans or wartime posters. It is a tool used to change what people think by showing only some information, getting feel strong emotions, and sometimes even spreading lies.. It doesn't always scream for attention—it works quietly, controlling what we see, hear, and believe. The most effective propaganda tricks are those we don't even question when we are afraid & we lack knowledge about the information, which makes it easier to control. Propaganda also plays the “one-sided story” game

I think that Network propaganda isn't just a lie. In my sense, it is an art of twisting Facts and emotions. The Chittagong Hill Tracts conflict over the years, propaganda has played a massive role in shaping public opinion about the Indigenous people. Misinformation has led many to believe that they are outsiders, troublemakers, or even separated wanting to divide the country. Narratives like "They want to leave our country," or "They are a threat to national unity," have been repeatedly pushed through media, education, and political discourse.

Conclusion

The reality? People in the Chittagong Hill Tracts have lived there for a long time. But some stories make them look bad and hide their real problems. Bengali settlers are also shown in different ways — sometimes good, sometimes bad. The real truth is in the middle, but these stories only show one side.

This kind of false information causes big problems. It makes people fight, builds hate, and leads to unfair rules. It makes neighbors turn against each other and spreads fear. Wrong information spreads fast and hurts not just one person but whole communities

I invite you all to challenge the narratives you encounter. Don't just accept stories at face value— seek multiple perspectives, ask questions, and demand truth over convenience. The power to resist propaganda lies in critical thinking. And remember, a well-informed society is a free society.

Thank you.

Background of Network Propaganda

Network propaganda refers to spreading information, misinformation, and disinformation through digital platforms, particularly social media and online platforms. The concept was promoted with the rise of social media, where information spreads rapidly without rigorous fact-checking. *Manipulation, Disinformation, and Radicalization in American Politics* (2018) highlights how online ecosystems enable the strategic spread of biased narratives, often reinforcing political polarization. The process between algorithms and influencers allows misleading or manipulative content to gain traction, sometimes blurring the line between facts and propaganda.

Network propaganda is crucial in shaping public opinion, influencing elections, and even fueling social conflicts. Its effectiveness lies in its ability to exploit cognitive biases and create alternative realities for different audience segments. Governments, interest groups, and even corporations leverage network propaganda to sway public discourse. Addressing its impact requires media literacy, fact-checking mechanisms, and policy interventions to ensure a more informed digital space.

Summary of this project

I was writing about the topic of propaganda issues in the Chittagong Hill Tracts. It is about the long history of Bangladesh. about the Chittagong Hill Tracts (CHT) conflict in Bangladesh. It identifies key stakeholders, including the Indigenous Peoples (represented by groups like PCJSS, formed in 1973, and UPDF, founded in 1998), the Government of Bangladesh, Bengali settlers (with significant settlement occurring between 1979 and 1983), and the Kuki-Chin National Front (KNF), which emerged more recently. CHT, and portrays its actions as necessary for maintaining peace and order, sometimes downplaying historical grievances and human rights concerns and highlighting violence by indigenous groups, particularly during the Shanti Bahini insurgency (1977-1997). Policies like the state-sponsored Bengali settlement programs, especially between 1979 and 1983, and the continued heavy military presence are discussed in the context of their potential propagandistic effects. The 1997 Peace Accord and its incomplete implementation are also central to the government's narrative.

Indigenous organizations like PCJSS, formed in 1973, and UPDF, founded in 1998, present counter-narratives focusing on historical autonomy, land rights (particularly impacted by the Kaptai Dam construction in the 1960s), cultural survival, and alleged injustices faced due to government policies and settler influx since the 1970s. Their communication often includes strong accusations of human rights violations and demands for greater autonomy, referencing the unfulfilled promises of the 1997 Peace Accord. Internal divisions within the indigenous community, such as the split between PCJSS (which signed the 1997 accord) and UPDF (which opposed it), also led to differing narratives. It's happened in all situations, people are divided in

Extemporaneous Speech

An Extemporaneous Speech is a type of speech that is delivered with little preparation but is based on thorough knowledge of the topic. Unlike a memorized or manuscript speech, it is not read word-for-word nor completely impromptu. Instead, the speaker uses brief notes or an outline and speaks naturally, adapting their message to the audience in real time. I chose extemporaneous speech because it allows me to talk about network propaganda in the Chittagong Hill Tracts in a way that's clear, thoughtful, and meaningful. It helps me build ethos by showing that I've studied the topic and understand its complexity. It also gives space for pathos, so I can connect emotionally with

the audience and highlight the real impact on people's lives. At the same time, it supports logos by letting me present facts and logical points in an organized way. This method gives me the right balance between being prepared and speaking from the heart.

Balance of Preparation and Flexibility

Network propaganda in the CHT is a complex and sensitive issue, involving media manipulation, ethnic tensions, and state narratives. Extemporaneous speech allows me to:

- Be well-informed and organized.
- Respond flexibly to audience reactions or questions.
- Adjust tone and examples based on the audience's understanding or sensitivity.

Natural and Engaging Delivery

Propaganda is a topic that demands audience trust. Builds credibility and rapport.

- Helps humanize the impact on the local communities.
- Keeps the audience actively engaged rather than just informed.

Updated or Real-time References

Since online propaganda and media trends change rapidly, this method:

- Let me insert recent developments or examples without changing the whole script.
- Makes the speech current and relevant.

Promotes Critical Thinking

Extemporaneous speaking reflects my understanding rather than just memory.

- I've truly analyzed the issue.
- I can think critically and ethically about the effects of media on indigenous communities.

Demographic analysis of my audience

Category	Description
Audience	1. Local community student 2. Chittagong Hill ethnic people
Age Group	1. 18 -30 years old will be university students, and young people are the audience. 2. 30-40 years old will be the working-class, tutors, etc secondary audience
Education Level	1. University students who are studying college, university and media. 2. Curious students 3. People who know digital ethics and media literacy.
Occupation and Interests	1. Teachers and students 2. Media professionals 3. Activists 4. People with knowledge of algorithm biases 5. Social media users
Location	a. Urban-based region, with high social media usage.
Media Consumption Point	Engaging in social media platforms blend of tv news source and online news source

Challenges They Face	• Struggles to differentiate propaganda from fact • No point of view on the contents • Lack of digital literacy
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Audience Analysis

Cognitive analysis of my audience:

1. Awareness of Online Misinformation

The audience is beginning to understand how false and misleading information spreads online through biased content, fake news, or manipulated visuals.

2. Emotional Reactions to Media

They may tolerate emotional influence, especially when content aligns with their existing beliefs or cultural narratives, making them more vulnerable to propaganda.

3. Recognition of Persuasion Tactics

With increasing media literacy, many are now able to identify techniques like fear appeals, emotional manipulation, or selective storytelling.

4. Feeling of Betrayal or Mistrust

Upon learning they've been misled, they may feel disappointed or betrayed, which creates a strong emotional impact and a need to seek the truth

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Learnings and Outcomes (Self-reflection):

- Learned how to research and write an effective speech on a complex issue.
- Improved my public speaking and critical thinking skills.
- Gained a better understanding of propaganda, media narratives, and audience perception.